

Local History and Heritage Groups in Leicestershire

Caroline Wessel

LAHS Networks Project

The Networks Project was launched at the History and Heritage Fair held at Vaughan College, Leicester in October 2007. The Networks Project aims to cover the role formerly undertaken by the Leicestershire Local History Council. Networks hopes to provide opportunities for the many and varied groups in the county focusing on history, archaeology, heritage and culture to make contact, and to enjoy and appreciate each other's achievements. For more information about the Networks Project, please contact Caroline Wessel, Email cmwessel@aol.com

The following list of local history and heritage groups in Leicestershire has been compiled from a questionnaire sent out earlier in 2008 as part of the work of the LAHS Networks Project. The Society would like to warmly thank all those groups who have taken the time to fill in the questionnaire and submit details for publication in this edition of the Leicestershire Historian.

Ashby de la Zouch History Society

Chris Tandy, 69 Leicester Road, Ashby de la Zouch, Leics LE65 1DD

Tel. 01530 415654 E-mail christandy@hotmail.co.uk

We provide a series of talks and visits of local historical interest for local residents and guests. Meetings 2nd Monday of the month, Ivanhoe Community College, Ashby. 7.30. All welcome.

Billesdon Local History Group

Mel Vlaeminke, c/o 5 Market Place, Billesdon, Leics. LE7 9AJ

Tel. 0116 259 6319 E-mail billesdon.lhg@homecall.co.uk

Founded in 1986, BLHG aims to research the history of Billesdon and its surrounding area, and disseminate findings by publications, exhibitions and special events.

Birstall & District Local History Society

Michael Smith, 25 Holt Road, Birstall, Leicester LE4 4AQ

Tel. 0116 267 5792 E-mail mikejwsmith@tiscali.co.uk

We spread the virtues and pleasures of local history as a pursuit by means of monthly B.L.H.S. meetings. We also

research Birstall & Wanlip history, compile an archive, and write up and publish our findings in a popular and acceptable form.

Boston Brass Collection, The

Mrs Audrey Boston, Linton House, 1 Westhaven Ct, Market Bosworth, Nuneaton, CV13 0PR. Tel. 01455 290462 E-mail a.bostoncadeby@btopenworld.com

The history of monumental brasses, their origins, and further use in this century.

Small part of the original brass collection previously held at All Saints Church, Cadeby.

Bottesford 'Living History' Community Heritage Project

Neil Fortey, 4 Church Street, Bottesford, Nottingham NG13 0BX (but in Leicestershire)

Tel. 01949 843320 E-mail neilfortey@metronet.co.uk

We are assembling an archive of local history from Bottesford and the surrounding area and making it accessible to the local community. HLF Funded Project. Local history leaflets, book, exhibitions, Living History days, interactive.

Website: www.bottesfordhistory.org.uk

Broughton Astley Heritage Society

Mr R.W. Wrathall (Secretary), 9 New Inn Close, Broughton Astley, Leicester LE9 6SU

Tel. 01455 285366 E-mail rwrathall@talktalk.net

We are a friendly group of heritage enthusiasts seeking to protect and record the local heritage using monthly meetings, lectures, exhibitions, visits and research.

Website:

broughtonastley.leicestershireparishcouncils.org/27185.html#broughtonastleyheritagesociety

Burbage Heritage and Tourism Group

Arthur Cross, 48 Lychgate Lane, Burbage, Leics. LE10 2DS

Tel. 01455 633045

We are dedicated to obtaining a museum to show our many archaeological artefacts, some of national importance.

Castle Hill Country Park, Friends of

Wendy Fearn, Secretary.

Tel. 07944 415 824 E-mail fochcp@aol.com

We assist the council in the upkeep and maintenance of our local park and encourage more people to use Castle Hill Country Park.

Centre for English Local History

Christopher Dyer, University of Leicester, 5 Salisbury Road, Leicester LE1 7QR

Tel. 0116 252 2765 E-mail cd50@le.ac.uk

We teach and research local history throughout England. In particular, we run an MA course in English Local History, and supervise MPhil and PhD degrees in local history.

Charley Heritage Group

Maureen Havers, St Joseph's, Abbey Road, Nr Coalville LE67 4UA

Tel. 01509 503943 E-mail m.havers@virgin.net

We research the history of Charley and its environs, and aim to make Charley more widely known throughout the UK.

Churches Together in Leicester City Centre

Canon Barry Naylor, The Cathedral Centre, 21 St Martin's, Leicester LE1 5DE

Tel. 07757 853 621 E-mail barry.naylor@leccofe.org

Together is a group of Leicester churches of all denominations (including the Cathedral) that have got together to promote their history and heritage, and who work for closer relationships between churches of different denominations and traditions in Leicester City Centre.

Croft Heritage Group

Pat Parkin-Moore (Chair), 41 Arbor Road, Croft, Leicester LE9 3GB

Tel. 01455 284466 E-mail patparkinmoore@btinternet.com

Our aim is to study the history of Croft and produce a booklet.

Desford & District Local History Society

Paula Casson, 47 Desford Road, Newbold Verdon, Leicester LE9 9LG

Tel. 01455 823166 E-mail p.e.casson@btinternet.com

Meetings with speakers (4 per year), visits (5 or 6 per year). Exhibition planned for Feb 2009.

Earl Shilton & District Local History Group

Mrs Linda Bent, 51 Belle Vue Road, Earl Shilton, Leics. LE9 7HX

Tel. 01455 842430 Reserve contact: David Herbert E-mail adavher@btinternet.com

We promote interest in the local area and its heritage.

East Midlands Oral History Archive

Colin Hyde, EMOHA, Centre for Urban History, University of Leicester, University Road, Leicester LE1 7RH. Tel. 0116 252 5065 E-mail emoha@le.ac.uk

We preserve, catalogue and make accessible the oral history records of Leicester, Leicestershire and Rutland. Also oral history interviewing, and training and support for others who wish to carry out their own oral history projects.

Enderby Heritage Group

Mark Carne, 51 Grass Acres, Leicester LE3 2UR

Tel. 0116 289 6783 E-mail cmarkcarne@hotmail.com

We preserve the past of Enderby for future generations. Talks, annual open event for all village groups, recording the village, research into Aldeby. All welcome, no membership fee, £1 per meeting, but activities are free, e.g. recording activities/places in the parish. Articles about the work of the group have appeared in the *Leicestershire Historian* for 2005 and 2007.

Fleckney History Group

Betty Morley, 38 Victoria Street, Fleckney, LE8 8AZ

Tel. 0116 240 2123

We foster and promote interest in history and artefacts relating to Fleckney. We organise and maintain a museum and make the museum archive available to the public. We hold monthly meetings for members and the general public.

Grace Dieu Priory, Friends of

Paula Godson, 5 Sandhills Close, Belton, Loughborough, Leics LE12 9TT

Tel. 01530 222399 E-mail paula@snowmoon.co.uk

We aim to maintain Grace Dieu Priory ruins and site, and to educate the public about its history and archaeology. Guide books and Ghost Walk books for sale. Guided walks, ghost walks, and events at the Priory, eg Carols in the Cloisters, summer medieval fete.

Great Bowden Heritage Group

Rosemary Culkin, 36 Knights End Road, Great Bowden, Leics. LE16 7EY

Tel. 01858 463079

E-mail theculkins@knightsend.freemove.co.uk

We encourage local people to be interested in our heritage through research, exhibitions, publications and events.

Greater Wigston Historical Society

Mrs Tricia Berry, 7 Wensleydale Road, Wigston, Leics. LE18 3RX

Tel. 0116 288 0156 E-mail triciaberry7@yahoo.co.uk

Aims: to research and publish aspects of Wigston and district's past. Activities: monthly meetings with lectures in winter and trips out during summer. Bulletin produced 3 times a year with news and members' research. We are building a collection of Transactions.

Heart of Albion

Bob Trubshaw, 2 Cross Hill Close, Wymeswold, Loughborough, Leics. LE12 6UJ

Tel. 01509 880725 E-mail bobtrubs@indigogroup.co.uk

Publishers of local history, folklore and mythology.

Hinckley Civic Society

Howard Wilkins (Chair), 46 Brookside, Burbage, Hinckley, Leics. LE10 2TL

Tel. 01455 635043 or 07753 831 499

E-mail chair@hinckleycivicsociety.org.uk

We are dedicated to preserving all that is good in the historical and natural environment of the Hinckley Urban core, and learning more about the history of our town.

Website: www.hinckleycivicsociety.org.uk

Hinckley Local History Group

Mrs Jill Beavin, 4 Castlemaine Drive, Hinckley, Leics. LE10 1RY

Tel. 01455 615634 E-mail hugh.beavin@btinternet.com

We meet monthly for historical talks and visits to places of interest. We produce *The Hinckley Historian* twice a year (no. 60 just produced), a valuable archive of Hinckley's history and the surrounding area.

Hinckley Search Society

John Caluori, 16 Grey Crescent, Newtown Linford, Leics. LE6 0AA

Tel. 01530 244007 E-mail john_caluori@tiscali.co.uk

Metal detecting group founded 1980. We promote the hobby, history, archaeology, compare and research finds. Member of National Council for Metal Detecting (£5 million insurance for all members). Finds on British Museum Portable Antiquities database. Suitable land welcomed.

Ibstock Historical Society

Rachel Elliott, c/o 12 Chapel Street, Ibstock, Leics. LE67 6HE

Tel. 01530262882 E-mail ibstockcommunity@hotmail.com

We research, report and record change in Ibstock. Monthly meeting last Tuesday of each month, check www.ibstock.org for details

Jewry Wall Museum, Friends of

Angela Monkton, 19 Queensgate Drive, Birstall, Leicestershire LE4 3JS

Tel. 0116 267 3479 E-mail am116@le.ac.uk

We support Jewry Wall Museum, Leicester, and aim to keep it open to the public by holding events to bring local archaeology to the public.

Kibworth History Society

Mr Norman Harrison, 6 The Tithings, Kibworth, Leics. LE8 0PU

Tel. 0116 279 6171 E-mail n.harrison6@btopenworld.com

We promote the study of the history of Kibworth and the local area, including family history. We hold monthly meetings and organise and publish research projects. Membership open to all persons wanting to support and/or participate in the Society's activities. Visitors to meetings welcome.

Leicester Cathedral, Friends of

Celia Davies (Chairman), 50 Main Street, Peckleton, Leicestershire LE9 7RE

Tel. 01455 822604 E-mail celiadavies@graff.plus.com

We exist for a number of purposes, one of which is to cherish the Cathedral's history and heritage.

Leicester City Council, Planning Policy and Design

Judith Carstairs, Planning Policy and Design, New Walk Centre, Welford Place, LE1 6ZG

Tel. 0116 252 7296

E-mail judith.carstairs@leicester.gov.uk

Local planning authority, we advise on historic building conservation.

Leicester Civic Society

Stuart Bailey, 48 Meadow Avenue, Loughborough, Leics. LE11 1JT

Tel. 01509 520904

E-mail chairman@leicestercivicsociety.org.uk

Preservation and improvement of the historic built environment of the City of Leicester. We are committed to working with all other heritage bodies in Leicester and to using our resources to publicise their activities free of charge. We publish the journal *Leicester Citizen*.

Leicester Decorative and Fine Arts Society

Ruth Turner, 17 Launde Road, Oadby, Leicester LE2 4HH

Tel. 0116 271 3814 E-mail turner@brassey.demon.co.uk

Promotion, cultivation and enjoyment of the decorative and fine arts. Member of National Association of Decorative and Fine Arts Societies. Nine monthly lectures by experts (guests welcome), study days and visits, social events, volunteering eg Church Recorders, Young Arts.

Leicester Group of the Victorian Society

Mr Jon Goodall, 75 Kings Drive, Leicester Forest East, Leics. LE3 3JE

Tel. 0116 239 3744

We promote appreciation of all aspects of the Victorian and Edwardian eras, with particular emphasis on architecture. Monthly talks and visits, guided walks etc.

Leicester Literary and Philosophical Society (founded 1835)

Dr M. Hamill, Hon. Secretary, Leicester Literary and Philosophical Society, c/o New Walk Museum, 53 New Walk, Leicester LE1 7EA.

Tel. 0116 270 3413

E-mail secretary@leicesterlitandphil.org.uk

Lectures/discussions with eminent speakers on the arts, literature, natural history, philosophy, sciences. held fortnightly 7.30pm, alternate Mondays at New Walk Museum, spring/winter.

Website: www.leicesterlitandphil.org.uk

Leicestershire Archaeological and Historical Society

Dr Alan McWhirr, 37 Dovedale Road, Leicester LE2 2DN
Tel. 0116 270 3031 E-mail alan@dovedale2.demon.co.uk

We promote the study of history, archaeology, antiquities and architecture of the county. Two annual publications, *Transactions* and *Leicestershire Historian*, and two newsletters. 12 lectures a year Oct-April at New Walk Museum. LAHS library at The Guildhall.

Website: <http://www.le.ac.uk/lahs/>

Leicestershire Industrial History Society (L.I.H.S.)

David Lyne, 10 Somerville Road, Leicester LE3 2ET
Tel. 0116 291 9706 E-mail LIHS99@ntlworld.com

The study and appreciation of Industrial History.

Leicestershire Museums Archaeological Fieldwork Group

Peter Liddle, Room 500, Rutland Building, County Hall, Glenfield, Leicester LE3 8TE

Tel. 0116 305 8326 E-mail pliddle@leics.gov.uk

The Fieldwork Group co-ordinates local community archaeology and subject interest groups around Leicestershire and Rutland, runs a lecture and tours programme, and arranges training and information in partnership with the County Museums Service.

Leicestershire Villages

Chris Poole, Leicestershire County Council, County Hall, Glenfield, Leicester, LE3 8TE

Tel 0116 3055677 E-mail cpoole@leics.gov.uk

Access to the County Council's services on-line. The history pages are about putting family and local history on-line to share with others, both inside and outside the county. An article on Leicestershire Villages appeared in the *Leicestershire Historian* 2006.

Website: www.leicestershirevillages.com

Leicestershire & Rutland Family History Society

Joan Rowbottom (secretary), 37 Cyril Street, Leicester LE3 2FF

E-mail joanrowbottom@hotmail.com

Local family history society preserving indexes, films, fiches, books relating to Leicester, Leicestershire and Rutland, and making them available to all.

Website: www.lrfhs.org.uk

Leicestershire and Rutland Gardens Trust

Sue Blaxland, Secretary, 3 Vicarage Close, Syston, Leicester LE7 1HE

Tel. 0116 260 9748 E-mail sue.blaxland@tiscali.co.uk

We protect, stimulate interest and enjoyment in, and understanding of our heritage of parks and gardens in Leicestershire and Rutland. A lively programme of events, including visits, lectures and study days. Also opportunities for involvement in our work of research and recording.

Leicestershire and Rutland Museums Forum

Robin Clarke, Holly Hayes, 216 Birstall Road, Birstall, Leicester LE4 4DG

Tel. 0116 267 0050 E-mail rclarke@leics.gov.uk

Network supporting the work of independent museums in Leicester, Leicestershire and Rutland.

Long Whatton History Society

Geoff Smith, 47 West End, Long Whatton, Loughborough, Leics. LE12 5DW

E-mail geoff@greasley.gotadsl.co.uk

We research the history of the village and collect and preserve historical records, documents and photographs. Many of our records etc. are available on-line.

Website:

www.leicestershirevillages.com/longwhatton/longwhattonhistorysociety.html

Loughborough Archaeological and Historical Society

Sara Haynes, 25 Woodbrook Road, Loughborough, LE11 3QB

Tel. 01509 232953 E-mail Sarahaynes1@aol.com

We promote the study of archaeology, antiquities, history and related studies, and encourage exploration of the past of Loughborough and district.

Loughborough War Memorial Museum

Peter Crooks, 23 Atherstone Road, Loughborough, Leics. LE11 2SH

Tel. 01509 268561 or 07854 672 747

E-mail Carillonmuseum@talktalk.net

First and still finest Carillon (bells) in Britain. Ground, first and second floors, preservation and display of military memorabilia; third floor Carillon keyboard and bells.

Lutterworth Museum

Geoff Smith, 20 Dunton Road, Broughton Astley, Leics. LE9 6NB

Tel 07810 230 612 E-mail alijgeoff@aol.com

We preserve and display the history of Lutterworth and its surrounding villages.

Market Bosworth Society

C.J. Peat, 7 Main Street, Carlton, Nuneaton, Warks CV13 0BZ.

Tel 01455 290934

We aim to secure the preservation, conservation and enhancement of the built and natural environments of Market Bosworth and its environs. Annual programme of meetings and visits. Current working groups on: Oral history recording and publication, Town Trail project, Educational Links, Preservation of old maps and photographs, Snapshot project.

Website: www.leicestershirevillages.com/marketbosworth

Media Archive for Central England (MACE)

Richard Shenton, 1 Salisbury road, Leicester LE1 7QR

Tel 0116 252 5066 E-mail rs228@le.ac.uk

MACE is the public sector regional film archive for the Midlands. We aim to collect, preserve and show the filmed heritage of the region.

Melton & Belvoir Search Society

Denis Wells, 36 Framland Drive, Melton Mowbray, Leics. LE13 1HY

Tel. 01664 859350 E-mail dwell36@ntlworld.com

We aim to recover, research and record all items of interest lost and/or buried in the ground with the aid of metal detectors. We also offer a free recovery service available to anyone who has lost anything metallic of value (to them).

Nailstone Local History Group

Kathy Harman, 37 Church Road, Nailstone, Nr Nuneaton, Warks CV13 0QH

Tel. 01530 263988 E-mail Kathybob@btinternet.com

Investigation of the history and surroundings of the parish of Nailstone, Leicestershire. Group meets irregularly and includes natural history, Heritage Warden and Tree Warden.

Parks Services, Leicester City Council

Stefan Cabaniuk (Parks Officer), Park House, Abbey Park, Abbey Park Road, Leic. LE4 5AQ

Tel. 0116 233 3024

E-mail Stefan.Cabaniuk@leicester.gov.uk

We promote and publicise the history, heritage and amenities of Leicester's parks and green spaces. Leaflets available on each of Leicester's parks and their history. An article on Beaumont Leys and its Parks appeared in the *Leicestershire Historian* for 2007.

Ratby Local History Group

Dr D.L. Harwood, 8 Groby Road, Ratby, Leicester LE6 0LJ

Tel. 0116 239 4168 E-mail doug.harwood@virgin.net

We aim to raise interest in the history of Ratby through research, talks, displays and publications.

Record Office for Leicestershire, Leicester and Rutland

Evie Wattam, Long Street, Wigston Magna, Leicestershire LE18 2AH

Tel. 0116 257 1080 E-mail recordoffice@leics.gov.uk

We house the archives and records of Leicestershire, Leicester and Rutland, and make them available for study to the general public.

Richard III Society – East Midlands Branch

Sally Henshaw – Secretary, 28 Lyncroft Leys, Scraptoft, Leicester LE7 9UW

Tel 0116 243 3785

The Society promotes research into the life and times of Richard III. We believe many features of traditional

accounts of his character and career are neither supported by sufficient evidence nor are reasonably tenable. The Society has over 4,500 members worldwide and is open to all who have an interest in the life and times of Richard III.

Rutland Local History & Record Society

Rutland County Museum, Catmose Street, Oakham, Rutland LE15 6HW

Tel. 01572 758440

We promote the study of the history and archaeology of the ancient county of Rutland through lectures, meetings, village visits, an annual journal, publishing, research and fieldwork.

Shepshed History Society

Mrs M.J. Schulz, 39 Griffin Close, Shepshed, Leics. LE12 9QQ

Tel. 01509 507815

We promote awareness of our local history and provide a cultural interest for local people.

Swordweaver Armoury

Julian Adams, 45 Northfield Ave, Wigston, Leicester LE18 1FX

Tel. 0116 288 3945 E-mail swordweaver@googlemail.com

Swordweaver is a working armoury making armour from the 7th Century to the 17th Century.

Thurcaston & Cropston Local History Society

Peter Smith (Secretary), 8 Bradgate Road, Cropston, Leicester LE7 7GA

Tel. 0116 236 7365

E-mail peterandjane.smith@btopenworld.com

Monthly speaker meetings to learn about the history of Thurcaston, Cropston and surrounding area. Supporting research by some of our members.

Website:

www.leicestershirevillages.com/cropston/localhistorysociety.html

Thurmaston Heritage Group

Sue Lewis / Dawn Kirkwood, 15 Margaret Close, Thurmaston, Leicester LE4 8GL

Tel. 0116 221 6061 E-mail ianandsue-lewis@hotmail.com and dak0904@hotmail.com

We research and record the history and heritage of Thurmaston and its people.

U3A History

Bob Gill, 27 The Broadway, Oadby, Leicester LE2 2HF

Tel. 0116 270 8570 E-mail r.gill27@talktalk.net

The pleasures of learning are a driving force in U3A and members are both learners and teachers. We are Oadby and Wigston U3A History Group; there are 14 other U3As in Leicestershire.

University of Leicester Archaeological Services (ULAS)

Nick Cooper, University of Leicester Archaeological Services, University Road, Leicester LE1 7RH

Tel. 0116 252 2847/8 E-mail njc9@le.ac.uk

ULAS carries out archaeological excavations, analysis of finds, and publication of results mainly from the Midlands.

ULAS staff provide talks and displays of archaeological findings for local societies and the public, and have a particular interest in Leicester, Leicestershire and Rutland.

Vaughan College, Institute of Lifelong Learning, University of Leicester

Reception, Vaughan College, St Nicholas Circle, Leicester LE1 4LB

Tel. 0116 251 7368 E-mail lifelonglearning@le.ac.uk,

We currently offer Higher Education Certificates in Modern Social History and in Local History Research, and hold history-related short courses and events. Also the venue for Vaughan Historical and Archaeological Society meetings. An article on research-based courses at Vaughan college appears in this edition of the *Leicestershire Historian* in the article entitled 'Hands on History'.

Website: www.le.ac.uk/lifelonglearning/

Victorian Studies Centre (VSC), Department of English, University of Leicester

Mrs Sue Lloyd, Administrator, Victorian Studies Centre, Department of English, University of Leicester, University Road, Leicester LE1 7RH

Tel. 0116 252 3943 E-mail sl71@le.ac.uk

The VSC is the oldest established centre of its kind in the UK. It encourages interdisciplinary research on the 19C and runs an internationally known MA course in Victorian Studies. Public lectures (autumn), seminar series (spring) and conferences - all open to the public.

Wigston Framework Knitters Museum

Alan Kind, MBE, 106 Saffron Road, Wigston, Leicester LE18 4UN

Tel. 0116 278 2684 E-mail alan.kind@btopenworld.com

Preservation of Master Hosier's house and two-storey nineteenth-century frameshop.

Witan Archaeology

Stephen Saunders, 5 Sperry Court, Ibstock, Leics LE67 6JN

Tel. 07957 722 464 E-mail Repton873@aol.com

The study of archaeology and history in North West Leics. We promote this study through children's education with the Young Historian Project, run in partnership with Ashby Museum.

Wolds Historical Organisation

Patricia Baker, 14 Orchard Way, Wymeswold, Loughborough, LE12 6SW

Tel 01509 881473

E-mail patriciaannebaker@btinternet.com

We promote awareness of the history of the Wolds villages.

Woodhouse and Woodhouse Eaves Local History Group

Maureen Axon (Secretary), 30 Church Hill, Woodhouse Eaves, Leics. LE12 8RT

Tel. 01509 890788 E-mail ma@ackymo.fsnet.co.uk

Monthly meetings with guest speaker, historical talks where possible.

Wymondham & Edmondthorpe Civic Society

Barry Watkins (Chairman), Badgers Sett, Nurses Lane, Wymondham, Leics. LE14 2AS

Tel. 01572 787669 E-mail bazzwat@hotmail.co.uk

We promote high standards of planning and architecture in, or affecting, Wymondham or Edmondthorpe and aim to secure preservation, protection, development and improvement of features of historic or public interest. Also interest in geography, history, natural history and architecture of Wymondham and Edmondthorpe.

Website: <http://wecs.le14.co.uk>

All details above have been submitted by members of the groups concerned and are believed to be correct as at the time of publication. However it is inevitable that information of this nature can go out of date quickly - contact details change, email and web site addresses change, new web sites are added, plus meeting times and places change. If you experience difficulties in trying to contact any of the above groups, the local public library services can often help, as can internet websites such as Infolinx: www.infolinx.org and Google: www.google.co.uk.

We are aware that there are additional local history and heritage groups in Leicestershire who do not appear in the above list and we would like to include more of these in a supplementary list in the Leicestershire Historian for 2009.

**MEMBERS OF LOCAL HISTORY AND
HERITAGE GROUPS**

Is your Group not included here?

To ensure your group appears in
the next edition of the
Leicestershire Historian:

Please contact the Editor.